

project. She's got a great smile and a better laugh that makes you want to trust and confide in her.

Fae: *In her fae mien, Saffie has much the same air of energy that belies her stature, though her casual mortal clothes are replaced with voile that's a mixture of Renaissance and Edwardian pieces. It shouldn't go together at all, but somehow it does, in a charming, if sometimes a little delightfully chaotic, way. Her boggan extra eyebrows are highly expressive, often accenting her emotions in a way that makes her easy to read for those who know her. A small brown chimerical teddy bear with a deep voice, sarcastic demeanor, and surprising strength for its size is never far away from her, helping with one thing or another, and they banter constantly.*

With a sense of how to describe Saffie to the others worked out, Meg moves to the quirks and mannerisms that will help bring her character to life. She decides that Saffron has a notebook she brings with her everywhere that's full of doodles, sewing diagrams, and little bits of poetry, and that she brings out whenever the group is sitting still for any length of time. Meg also figures that Saffron tends to chew on her pens and pencils while she's thinking, and that her friends can often tell how worried or deep in thought she is by counting the number of chewed writing implements in her vicinity.

As far as goals and motivations go, on a basic level Saffie wants to keep the bar running and hopefully help expand it. She believes in her motley and loves helping them realize their dreams, and that keeps her plenty busy most of the time. In the longer term, she wants to delve into Kithain lore and maybe discover more about these past lives she's been remembering, especially as they pertain to the curse she's under. Lastly, she wants to research the occult history of Philadelphia and see what she can learn about its mysteries, and maybe even see if she can make contact with some Prodigals to learn what they're like. The rest of the group groans but Pete just points out Saffie's Curiosity Flaw and Meg smiles at the wonderful trouble it's likely to cause.

Speaking of the group, it's time to talk about character relationships a bit. Meg and Amy decide that Harper and Saffie have been close ever since they both went through the Chrysalis around the same time, with Saffie functioning as Harper's steady right hand and occasional voice of conscience, while Harper inspires Saffie to apply her mind to larger problems. After talking to Ricky, Meg figures that Saffie sees Colin as a sort of adorable younger brother, while Ricky teases that Colin is always trying to get Saffie to let her hair down and indulge more. As for Lucky... Dan tells Meg that having seen Saffie's Unseelie side before, probably due to her moonlight curse, Lucky is determined to bring it out more, while Meg feels that Saffie probably feigns exasperation at Lucky's sly manner but secretly loves gossiping and pulling pranks with the debonair pooka.

With all these factors in place, Meg takes a moment to sketch out Saffie's mortal life, noting that it will likely develop much more in play but wanting to have at least a basic sense of where she came from and who's still in her life. She decides that Saffie grew up in a quaint old small town in a rural area upstate and still is a bit of a country girl at heart, but came to the city for college and has since come to love city life after being shown around by locals like Harper and Lucky. She has a large family back home

in Newton, and still loves to go a few times a year to be out in the wilderness a bit and enjoy the quiet. Meg notes that it might be good to take a little bit of the Nature Realm at some point in the future to reflect Saffie's love of the countryside, while Pete privately thinks it might be fun to have the group take a field trip to Saffie's small hometown at some point, to provide a change of scenery and contrast the urban setting a bit. He writes down "trip to Newton" in his notes to revisit later.

At this point Meg feels that while she's certainly got more she can flesh out and detail, Saffie is ready for her prelude. Just for logistical purposes, Pete asks her to make a few notes about the any weapons or armor Saffie has, as well as what sort of items she routinely carries with her. With that last little bit of bookkeeping out of the way, Meg turns Saffie over to Pete for approval, and gets ready to begin her story.

The Prelude

A prelude is a special sort of personal session, often handled one on one between a player and a Storyteller. As the name implies, it covers events that happened before the opening of the chronicle, and is used to flesh out a character's backstory, establish foreshadowing for later events, and otherwise introduce plot hooks for possible future exploration. Sometimes a prelude may include more than one character, especially if two characters are close, but usually it's best to do them solo so that each character gets a time in the spotlight.

Many Storytellers like to cover a character's Chrysalis during the prelude, as it is a pivotal moment in a changeling's life and often colors their perceptions of other Kithain and the Dreaming in ways large and small. In addition, establishing what a character's life was like before she learned her true nature can provide a sense of contrast to the changeling existence that helps remind a player how magical and different a character's life is afterward.

A prelude is also a good time to test out certain traits and concepts, as well as make adjustments to a character before actual play begins. A player might be interested in a particular Art, for instance, but find out during the prelude that it doesn't work quite the way she wanted, and so trade it for a different Art before the chronicle gets underway. So long as the Storyteller approves of any mechanical changes, it's fine to move points around and change a few decisions.

Storytellers can find more information on running the prelude in Chapter Eight.

The Motley

Although ideally the players will have communicated a lot about their characters and possible ties between them during character creation, it's still a good idea to establish some basic facts about how the characters are connected. Are they a noble household that operates as a unit in Kithain politics? An oath-circle sworn to back each other? Or just a motley of changelings brought together by chance and opportunity? Some groups will want to establish firm connections before the chronicle begins, while others are content to have a few basic ties and then see how relationships develop during the game.